



The monkey selfie case

Two years ago, a monkey snatched a photographer's camera and took a selfie. PETA sued the photographer. <http://dgit.in/Moneykyfie>



Unusual Words

Here's a bank of unusual words for when you need to spice up your vocabulary. <http://dgit.in/unowords>

ZION Blaze RAM 8 GB 2400 MHz

A decent kit for your new rig



Price
₹5,200

Zion is a homegrown brand which has been around for about 20 years now. Their Blaze series is their line-up which is supposed to appeal to the enthusiasts and gamers.

From an aesthetics standpoint, the Zion Blaze series has a pretty standard red and black colour scheme on the heatspreader which resembles a stretched out batarang. The heat spreader is made out of aluminium but the thickness... well the thinness is concerning. It's barely a millimeter thick and it's affixed to the memory modules using double sided film tape.

The Zion Blaze 8 GB 2400 MHz modules are thus, rebranded SK Hynix units which also means messing with the SPD data in its entirety will be a pain in the rear end since SK tends to write-protect the SPD.

We started off with the AIDA64 Memory Benchmark and Super Pi to check how well the Zion Blaze compared to some of the other memory kits that we have. At 470.9 seconds, we're looking at a kit that's pretty much at par with most RAM kits out there.

The Zion Blaze series might be rebadged HK Hynix modules but they do perform quite well for the price. There's nothing exceptional about these modules and we surely wouldn't call them enthusiast grade. Also, in our overclocking test we could rake it up to 3000 MHz with a voltage level of 1.3V which is pretty decent as well. What we didn't like are the heatsinks which are way too thin to be called so and the thermal interface being double sided film wasn't helping when we started overclocking the unit. Overall, these are above average at best.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

TYPE: DDR4 | CAPACITY: 8 GB | RATED SPEED: 2400 MHz | TIMINGS: 17-17-17-39 | OEM: SK Hynix | PART NO: HMA41G56AFR8N | RANKS: 2 | BANKS: 16 | WARRANTY: 3+2 years.

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AMD Ryzen 7 1700X

Getting your money's worth

It's been a couple of months since AMD's Zen core based Ryzen CPUs hit the market and going by what we've been hearing from the retailers at the ground level, these processors seem to be selling like hotcakes. The Ryzen 7 1700X is practically identical to the Ryzen 7 1800X except for a 200 MHz lower clock speed across the board. The Ryzen 7 1700X is supposed to compete with the Intel Core i7 6800K but we don't have that so we compared it with the Core i7 5960X as well as the Core i7 7700K.

In Cinebench R15 we saw that in the single threaded run the Ryzen 7 1700X performs better than the Core i7 5960X but the Intel Core i7 7700K outdoes it but the tables turned in the multithreaded run. Both in Rise of the Tomb Raider and HITMAN we see that the Ryzen 7 processors don't do so well but the Ryzen 5 CPUs that came out a couple of months after the Ryzen 7 seem to do way better in comparison.

From what we've seen with the benchmarks, AMD's Ryzen 7 series offer a lot better performance given their much lower price point. AMD's gain is clearly with their competitive pricing and higher core counts in the sub-\$400 segment. While Indian pricing is clearly off thanks to lower shipments leading to inflation, they still to have very good performance. Another key noteworthy aspect is that the Ryzen 7 1700X offers a very similar performance as that of the 1800X for a much lower price tag. There isn't as much overclocking headroom with the 1700X but for the majority, that's a pretty good SKU to go with. And now, with Ryzen 3 series just around the corner, we're hoping that AMD's optimisation efforts will pay off for the better.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

8 Cores | 16 Threads | Base clock - 3.4 GHz | Boost clock - 3.8 GHz | XFR - 200 MHz | Process node - 14 nm | 16 MB L3 Cache | Slot - AM4

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